

Matter of Light

HIGGSFIELD GLOBAL FILM FESTIVAL · 5:00 · 21:9 · DEADLINE SEP 3, 11:59 PM PT

42 references 39 anchor frames 23 shots 34 run-sheet steps 5 gates ~200 images: ~76 video

How to use this kit. Print it, clip it, keep a pencil on it. Squares are things to tick; ruled lines are yours to fill; anything already printed in *grey italic* is a suggestion read from the project as of Aug 27 — confirm or strike it, don't trust it. The app is the source of truth for prompts; these sheets are the source of truth for **what is actually done**. Tables are generated from the bible's own data, so counts here always match the app they were printed from.

The last seven days

A compressed plan from today to the deadline. One line per day; write what actually happened beside it.

Aug 27	Finish Phase 0 — split the handles, remaining references, four lighting plates	<i>actual</i> _____
Aug 28	Gate A identity lock → anchor frames, Movements I and II	<i>actual</i> _____
Aug 29	Anchors Movement III → Gate B → stills reel → Gate C timing lock	<i>actual</i> _____
Aug 30	Cheap motion pass, all 23 shots → Gate D motion lock	<i>actual</i> _____
Aug 31	Final generation — Movement I, start Movement II	<i>actual</i> _____
Sep 1	Final generation — finish Movement II, Movement III	<i>actual</i> _____
Sep 2	Deflicker → upscale → grade → Gate E picture lock → sound	<i>actual</i> _____
Sep 3	Watermark + packshot, public post, rights pass, verify project — SUBMIT	<i>actual</i> _____

The five gates

A gate is a hard stop — nothing downstream begins until it holds. Date each one the moment it locks.

Gate A	Identity lock — every face, palette and plate final	☐ _____
Gate B	String lock — all 39 anchors on one contact sheet	☐ _____
Gate C	Timing lock — runtime, order and shot count freeze	☐ _____
Gate D	Motion lock — every seam confirmed at draft tier	☐ _____
Gate E	Picture lock — no further generation	☐ _____

Open decisions, still. (The title is decided: *Matter of Light*, everywhere.) ① @Drowning — define or delete: _____ ② Leviathan scale reference object: _____

How a film gets made here

The seventeen steps, in order. ♫ marks where a second pass is expected; ♫♫ where several are and the budget should say so. Grey rows are gates. Date each step when it is genuinely finished — not when it is started.

STEP	DONE	DATE
01 Decide the film before you open anything Fix the runtime, the shot count and how many identities appear on screen. Everything downstream derives from these three.	☐	_____
02 Create the project Make it inside the contest or workspace that will verify it, and generate everything there from then on.	☐	_____
03 Generate the governing rule sheet ♫ One image that fixes how your world's central visual idea works. It needs no identity and no location, so nothing blocks it.	☐	_____
04 Lighting plates, one per movement ♫ Empty frames, no characters. Key direction and palette only.	☐	_____
05 Train identity ♫ ♫ One trained Soul per character. Never two for one person.	☐	_____
06 Build the world ♫ Locations, props, creatures, effects. Plain backgrounds, one asset per sheet.	☐	_____
07 GATE A – identity lock Every reference side by side in one view. Look for a face that moved.	☐	_____
08 Anchor frames, in film order ♫ ♫ The first and last frame of every shot, generated as one continuous string rather than per scene.	☐	_____
09 GATE B – string lock Every anchor on one contact sheet, in order. Read it as a comic strip.	☐	_____
10 Stills reel Cut the anchors on a timeline at their real durations and watch the whole thing.	☐	_____
11 GATE C – timing lock Durations are now fixed. Changing one after this point breaks the total runtime.	☐	_____
12 Draft motion, cheap tier ♫ Every shot, lowest usable quality, no exceptions and no favourites.	☐	_____
13 GATE D – motion lock Watch it end to end at draft quality. Every camera move and seam is decided here.	☐	_____
14 Final shots ♫ ♫ Highest quality tier, one movement at a time, in film order.	☐	_____
15 Finish Deflicker first, then upscale, then grade. That order, always.	☐	_____
16 GATE E – picture lock No further picture changes. Audio is built against this cut and nothing else.	☐	_____
17 Audio, then deliver ♫ Score, dialogue, sound design. Audio is usually exempt from from-scratch rules — check, then reuse freely if it is.	☐	_____

The run sheet

All 34 steps in production order — grey dates are the compressed targets; overwrite them in pencil with the real ones.

	PHASE	STEP	DONE	DATE / TARGET
1	Phase 0	Read the from-scratch rule before you make anything	☒	Aug 26
2	Phase 0	Open the Cinema Studio festival project Cinema Studio — no generation yet · 21:9 · crop to 2.39:1 on export · Matter of Light/ ← create this now · save Project: MATTER OF LIGHT <i>project exists — folder reads “Matter of Light”; pick the one title</i>	☒	Aug 26
3	Phase 0	The aura rule — generate this before any character nano_banana_pro · no Soul · 21:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / States · save RULE-aura-A	☐	Aug 27
4	Phase 0	Oriane — train Soul V2 soul_2 · Soul V2, trained · 16:9 — sheets only, never 21:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters · save REF-oriane-## <i>started · 29 imgs across @Oriane + @Oriane-1 — sort into rest / ascended</i>	☐	Aug 27
5	Phase 0	Oriane damaged — the same Soul, a second sheet soul_2 · reuse the Oriane soul_id · 16:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters · save REF-oriane- damaged-A-## <i>started · @Oriane-damaged holds 3, needs 6-8</i>	☐	Aug 27
6	Phase 0	Oriane's mind ladder — the eight rungs soul_2 · same Oriane soul_id · 21:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / States · save LADDER-oriane-A · LADDER-oriane-B	☐	Aug 27
7	Phase 0	Caedom — two forms, one Soul soul_2 · Soul V2, a second identity · 16:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters · save REF- caedom-ascended-A-## · REF-caedom-mortal-A-## <i>started · @Caedom holds 24 — split ascended / mortal</i>	☐	Aug 27
8	Phase 0	Alder — the elder brother soul_2 · Soul V2, its own identity · 16:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters / ALDER · save REF-alder-A-## <i>started · split @KaiBrothers 16 by which boy is in frame</i>	☐	Aug 27
9	Phase 0	Wren — the younger brother soul_2 · Soul V2, its own identity · 16:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters / WREN · save REF- wren-A-## <i>then the height check: both A sheets side by side</i>	☐	Aug 27
10	Phase 0	Threadwright and Keepers soul_2 · one Soul, one Reference Element · 16:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters · save REF- threadwright-## · REF-keeper-## <i>started · @ThreadWright 18 · @TheKeepers 8 → @vigil</i>	☐	Aug 27
11	Phase 0	The Turned and the fused rider nano_banana_pro · group and detail sheets · 16:9 group · 21:9 rider · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters · save REF-turned-A-## · LEV-rider-A-## <i>started · @TheTurned 16 · @Wielder-Dominion 14 → @lev_rider</i>	☐	Aug 27
12	Phase 0	The seven domains — one sheet per Founding Stone nano_banana_pro · no Soul · 21:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / Characters / TURNED · save REF-bhollow · bwater · benergy · bgravity · bmetal · bthrall · banchor	☐	Aug 27
13	Phase 0	The attunement ladder — and the ceiling nano_banana_pro · no Soul · 21:9 · 00 · REFERENCES / States · save LADDER-attunement-A · LADDER-attunement-B	☐	Aug 27
14	Phase 0	Four lighting plates — three movements and the bombardment nano_banana_pro · 4K, no characters · 21:9 — these define the frame · 00 · REFERENCES / Lighting Plates · save PLATE-mv1-light-A · PLATE-mv2-light-A · PLATE-mv3-light-A · PLATE-mv3b-A <i>generate bar was last seen 4:3 / 30s — set 21:9 before these</i>	☐	Aug 27
15	Phase 0	Seventeen props, backgrounds, creatures and effects nano_banana_pro · plates and studies · 21:9 — all of them · 00 · REFERENCES / Props & Creatures + Locations + Effects · save PROP-* · BG-* · LEV-* · FX-*	☐	Aug 28
16	Gate A	Identity lock	☐	Aug 28

	PHASE	STEP	DONE	DATE / TARGET
17	Phase 1	Movement I look — 11 anchors soul_2 + soul_id · PLATE-mv1-light as reference · 21:9 · 4K · 01 · ANCHORS / MV1 The Sun · save F01 ... F09 · F36 · F37	☐	<u>Aug 28</u>
18	Phase 1	Movement II look — 14 anchors soul_2 + soul_id · PLATE-mv2-light as reference · 21:9 · 4K · 01 · ANCHORS / MV2 The Ocean · save F10 ... F22 · B01	☐	<u>Aug 28</u>
19	Phase 1	Movement III look — 14 anchors soul_2 + Reference Element · PLATE-mv3 / mv3b · 21:9 · 4K · 01 · ANCHORS / MV3 The Island · save F23 ... F35 · B02	☐	<u>Aug 29</u>
20	Gate B	String lock — the contact sheet	☐	<u>Aug 29</u>
21	Phase 2	Stills reel — watch all five minutes No generation — an edit, not a render · 21:9 timeline at 24fps · 01 · ANCHORS (export the string)	☐	<u>Aug 29</u>
22	Gate C	Timing lock	☐	<u>Aug 29</u>
23	Phase 3	Cheap motion pass — all 23 shots kling2_6 · veo3_1_lite — budget tier only · 21:9 · 1080p, not 4K · 02 · DRAFT MOTION · save DRAFT-S##	☐	<u>Aug 30</u>
24	Gate D	Motion lock	☐	<u>Aug 30</u>
25	Phase 4	Final — Movement I (S1 to S5) wan3_0 · seedance_2_5 · cinematic_studio_3_0 · 21:9 · 4K where the model allows · 03 · FINAL SHOTS · save FINAL-S01 ... S05	☐	<u>Aug 31</u>
26	Phase 4	Final — Movement II (S6 to S14) cinematic_studio_video_v2 · kling3_0 · veo3_1 · 21:9 · 4K · 03 · FINAL SHOTS · save FINAL-S06 ... S14	☐	<u>Aug 31-Sep 1</u>
27	Phase 4	Final — Movement III (S15 to S23) cinematic_studio_3_0 · wan3_0 · seedance_2_0 · 21:9 · 4K · 03 · FINAL SHOTS · save FINAL-S15 ... S23	☐	<u>Sep 1</u>
28	Phase 6	Finish — deflicker, then upscale, then grade upscale_video — 2K then 4K, in that order · 21:9 · 4K master · 04 · FINISHING · save MASTER-S##	☐	<u>Sep 2</u>
29	Gate E	Picture lock	☐	<u>Sep 2</u>
30	Phase 7	Rights and attribution pass	☐	<u>Sep 2</u>
31	Phase 7	Sound — and upload every audio file into the project generate_audio · ElevenLabs · Suno · — audio has no aspect ratio · 05 · AUDIO — upload every file here · save AUDIO-* inside the project	☐	<u>Sep 2</u>
32	Phase 7	Watermark and packshot — MVS component 1 nano_banana_pro · still, or an export · 21:9 master · 1:1 packshot · 06 · DELIVERY · save MASTER-film-watermarked	☐	<u>Sep 3</u>
33	Phase 7	Social post — MVS component 2, and the classic way to lose Any — a cut of the master, not a new render · 9:16 vertical · 1:1 square · 06 · DELIVERY · save Public post URL	☐	<u>Sep 3</u>
34	Phase 7	Verify the project, then submit 11:59 PM PT — aim for the morning, not the deadline	☐	<u>Sep 3</u>

Phase 0 — the 42 references

Tick when the **A variant is selected, named and favoured** in the project — generated is not done. The short blank takes the winning take number. Generate the Rule sheet first: everything else grades against it. B / C / D variants are optional and wait until Gate A.

RULE SHEET · 1

☐ RULE-aura Aura grammar — core vs hollow

STATE LADDER · 2

☐ LADDER-oriane Oriane — the mind ladder

☐ LADDER-attunement The Turned — attunement ladder

CHARACTER · 11

☐ REF-oriane Oriane

☐ REF-oriane-damaged Oriane — battle damage

☐ REF-oriane-ascended Oriane — the ascended state

☐ REF-caedom-ascended Caedom — the ascended form

☐ REF-caedom-mortal Caedom — the mortal form

☐ REF-alder Alder — the elder brother

☐ REF-wren Wren — the younger brother

☐ REF-threadwright The Threadwright

☐ REF-keeper The Keepers

☐ REF-turned The Turned — sixteen pursuers

☐ LEV-rider The fused Dominion wielder

LESSER BEING · 7

☐ REF-bhollow Turned — Hollows

☐ REF-bwater Turned — Water and its Phases

☐ REF-benergy Turned — Energy

☐ REF-bgravity Turned — Gravity

☐ REF-bmetal Turned — Metals

☐ REF-bthrall Turned — Thrall

☐ REF-banchor Turned — Anchor

LIGHTING PLATE · 4

☐ PLATE-mv1-light Movement I — the Sun

☐ PLATE-mv2-light Movement II — the Ocean

☐ PLATE-mv3-light Movement III — the Island

☐ PLATE-mv3b Movement III — bombardment

BACKGROUND · 6

☐ BG-courtyard Courtyard of worlds

☐ BG-nacre Nacre Beach

☐ BG-bloom The Corals and the abyss

☐ BG-vigil-temple The white temple

☐ BG-keepers-isle Keeper's Isle — the ground

☐ BG-machira Machira from orbit

PROP · 7

☐ PROP-shell The aura and the light-formed pieces

☐ PROP-hollowstone The Founding Stone

☐ PROP-coral Leviathan coral plating

☐ LEV-body The Leviathan — whole creature

☐ PROP-ore Iron ore — the spears

☐ PROP-ships The twelve ships

☐ PROP-tear The frozen tear

Phase 1 — the 39 anchors, in film order

One row per image. S shared join (one image, two shots) · B bridge (the seam itself) · M matched pair across a transition · · single. Tick when selected and named; the blank takes the take number. Work strictly top to bottom so shared joins are generated once and inherited.

MOVEMENT I · THE SUN		☐ F13 · S8 B	☐ F26 · S16 B	
☐ F01 · S1 A		☐ F14 · S9 A	☐ F27 · S17 A	
☐ F02 S S1 B / S2 A		☐ F15 · S9 B	☐ F28 · S17 B	
☐ F03 · S2 B		☐ F16 · S10 A	☐ F29 · S18 A	
☐ F04 · S3 A		☐ F17 S S10 B / S11 A	☐ B02 B S18 B / S19 A	
☐ F05 · S3 B		☐ B01 B S11 B / S12 A	☐ F30 S S19 B / S20 A	
☐ F06 · S4 A		☐ F18 · S12 B	☐ F31 · S20 B	
☐ F07 · S4 B		☐ F19 · S13 A	☐ F32 · S21 A	
☐ F08 · S5 A		☐ F20 · S13 B	☐ F33 · S21 B	
☐ F09 M S5 B		☐ F21 · S14 A	☐ F34 · S22 A	
		☐ F22 M S14 B	☐ F35 · S22 B	
MOVEMENT II · THE OCEAN		MOVEMENT III · THE ISLAND		
☐ F10 M S6 A		☐ F23 M S15 A	MOVEMENT I · THE SUN	
☐ F11 S S6 B / S7 A		☐ F24 · S15 B	☐ F36 · S23 A	
☐ F12 S S7 B / S8 A		☐ F25 · S16 A	☐ F37 · S23 B	

39 images, not 46 — 7 slots are shared joins or bridges. Batch of 4 per anchor, select 1. Attach the movement's lighting plate and the relevant Soul on every generation. **F35 is the film** — biggest batch, longest look.

Phases 3–4 — the 23 generations

Two boxes per shot: **draft** (cheap tier, Gate D) and **final**. A shot that fails three times leaves the queue for the escalation ladder — it does not get a quiet fourth try. Movement II must be generated in sequence: S7's end frame is S8's start frame.

ID	TC	DUR	SHOT	MODEL	DRAFT	FINAL	ATT / DATE
S1	0:00–0:16	16s	Rise out of the fire	wan3_0	☐	☐	_____
S2	0:16–0:34	18s	The courtyard of worlds	seedance_2_5	☐	☐	_____
S3	0:34–0:48	14s	“There must be risk”	cinematic_studio_3_0	☐	☐	_____
S4	0:48–1:02	14s	“He’s your brother”	minimax_hailuo (2.3)	☐	☐	_____
S5	1:02–1:20	18s	“Tomorrow” — the tear freezes	cinematic_studio_3_0	☐	☐	_____
S6	1:20–1:34	14s	108 years later — the run	cinematic_studio_video_v2	☐	☐	_____
S7	1:34–1:46	12s	Sixteen behind her, and a wall of ice	kling3_0	☐	☐	_____
S8	1:46–2:00	14s	Up the wall	cinematic_studio_video_v2	☐	☐	_____
S9	2:00–2:12	12s	The threadwright’s eyes	veo3_1	☐	☐	_____
S10	2:12–2:28	16s	The leviathan	seedance_2_0	☐	☐	_____
S11	2:28–2:38	10s	Running the flank	kling3_0	☐	☐	_____
S12	2:38–2:50	12s	The lightning river	cinematic_studio_video_v2	☐	☐	_____
S13	2:50–3:05	15s	The vortex, from the Sun	wan3_0	☐	☐	_____
S14	3:05–3:18	13s	The Stone leaves her	cinematic_studio_3_0	☐	☐	_____
S15	3:18–3:30	12s	Nacre Beach — the same sun	cinematic_studio_3_0	☐	☐	_____
S16	3:30–3:42	12s	Over the abyss	kling2_6	☐	☐	_____
S17	3:42–3:52	10s	Twelve ships	cinematic_studio_3_0	☐	☐	_____
S18	3:52–4:02	10s	The Temple does not answer	cinematic_studio_video_v2	☐	☐	_____
S19	4:02–4:12	10s	The Keepers kneel	seedance_2_0	☐	☐	_____
S20	4:12–4:26	14s	The mountain	wan3_0	☐	☐	_____
S21	4:26–4:34	8s	The garden replants itself	veo3_1_lite	☐	☐	_____
S22	4:34–4:48	14s	What Alder saw	veo3_1	☐	☐	_____
S23	4:48–5:00	12s	Tomorrow, again	cinematic_studio_3_0	☐	☐	_____

Finish order, always: deflicker → upscale (aigc) → grade. S13 ships silent. S20 gets the most attempts of anything in the film. Two passes, then it ships.

Daily log — forty seconds before work

Four capture boxes: ① folder tree expanded ② Elements → Characters ③ Liked filter ④ generate bar. Then the three counts, elements, and one line for what is blocking. Full window, never a crop; one screen per image; never scale down.

DAY	CAPTURES	REFS	ANCHORS	SHOTS	ELEMS	BLOCKED BY / NOTE
Aug 27	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Aug 28	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Aug 29	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Aug 30	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Aug 31	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Sep 1	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Sep 2	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____
Sep 3	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	_____ / 42	_____ / 39	_____ / 23	_____	_____

Before you submit — the list that disqualifies

Every line here is a rule with teeth, not a style note. An entry missing an MVS component does not compete.

- ☐ Official watermark + packshot on the final video
- ☐ Public post (IG / YT / X / Reddit) — film with both intact
- ☐ Post AND account load in a logged-out window
- ☐ Every asset still inside the submission project — deleted nothing
- ☐ All prompts swept — no novel term anywhere
- ☐ Licence clause read: exclusive / assignment / underlying works / moral rights
- ☐ English subtitles or VO for all dialogue · MP4/MOV · ≤4K · 21:9
- ☐ End card: “Original screen story by B.L. Barkey”
- ☐ Submitted — with a day of margin, not at 11:58

Where everything lives: app + prompts → director-bible.html · one-pager → production-sheet.html · capture plate → design/four-captures.png · this kit rebuilds with design/build-sheets.py.